

score high marks when overclocked through the front side bus.

Managing memory

Give your precious memory the pampering it needs to zip through your applications and games. Whether you have a surplus or shortage, tools such as Application Warp Memory Manager (AWMM) (www.majorgeeks.com) can take control of how well the system memory is used. With it, you can take snapshots of memory usage analysis and carry out tweaks best suited to your PC's configuration. You can even keep different settings across a variety of programs from games and 3D to business oriented applications. Whatever your need is, AWMM can regulate memory resources accordingly for optimal performance.

Turn up the juice!

One of the more aggressive means of overclocking is by pushing voltage levels higher.

The faster a chip processes data, the more power it would need to get the job done. Sometimes, you can squeeze a hundred megahertz more from a CPU just by increasing its input voltage.

But exercise caution as an overload of current can blow the chip to bits. The most effective way of pumping up voltage is to first overclock a component as high as possible using standard voltage. Once a chip has reached its limits, turn up the juice about one notch, approximately 0.1 V and try pushing up the speeds further. Repeat this process till you've reached no more than 2 volts for a CPU, anything higher would not only be dangerous, the benefits are really not worth it.

To increase voltage incrementally, check your motherboard manual on how to manipulate these settings. Since the precise settings vary across each motherboard model, you must begin this research before getting

down to the practice of it. If your board supports this exercise, you can either use DIP switches on the motherboard, or make the changes through the BIOS settings itself.

Play it safe!

Taking a strong, techie approach is the right spirit for overclocking. But remember, as with all things electrical, computers too have the potential to shock. Not only can sudden jolts of electricity feel rather uncomfortable, just think about what would happen to your PC if you inadvertently shorted a circuit. Always ground yourself

before dealing with the innards of a computer. You can either wear a grounding strip around your wrist or just touch the exposed part of an electrical appliance to discharge yourself.

Secondly, never fail to keep in mind your PC's warranty. Overclocking your PC will immediately void out that precious after-sales service and support, (technically at least). In fact, merely opening the cabinet is enough to deem that service contract null and void. We would recommend that you wait until the warranty period expires—it's vital to your peace of mind.

A GOOD WORKOUT

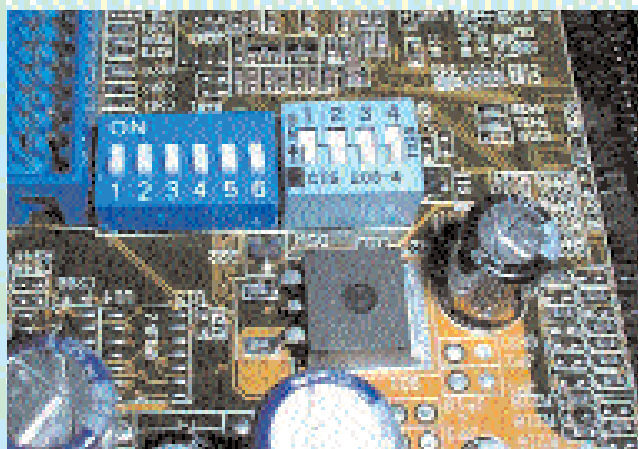
Download applications that will turbo-charge your computer



Overclocking video

If you've mastered the art of overclocking with your CPU, how about using those skills

to push your graphics card? The utility PowerStrip (www.entechtaiwan.com) makes it easy to manipulate the core



A shot of multiplier and voltage adjusting DIP switches.0



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